

Adobe Acrobat 8 Professional

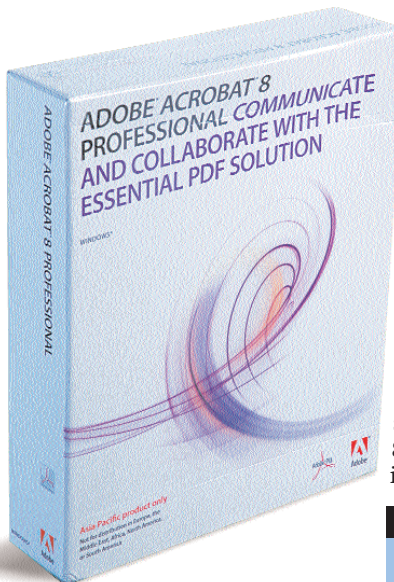
One step closer to the paperless office

Acrobat 8 Professional was recently released, and we received a copy for review. The platform-independent PDF needs no introduction: it is the most popular and versatile document format for registration forms, manuals, e-books, reports, brochures... but what do you get for the \$499 (Rs 22,500) price?

For starters (literally), the Getting Started screen makes things easy. The Start Meeting and Review & Comment button opens Adobe Connect, a replacement for Macromedia Breeze for hosting virtual meetings and collaborations. What strikes the eye is the revamped interface, something as revolutionary as what Microsoft did with

Office 2007—but not to worry; things have only gotten easier.

Acrobat 8 lets you combine different document formats such as PDFs, spreadsheets, Word documents, images, reports, etc. into a single PDF, something the older versions couldn't do. There is tighter control over redactions, giving top-secret documents enhanced security: sensitive text is permanently blacked out. This is an improvement; with previous versions, text blacked out in Microsoft Word was revealed when converted to PDF. What's more, you can even erase search keywords.



Finally, one can download and fill in PDF forms electronically and fax them. If someone mails you a PDF invitation or questionnaire and it doesn't contain standard form fields, Acrobat 8 Professional can detect and

convert flat lines into live form fields ready to accept data. This brings you one step closer to the paperless office.

Acrobat 8 integrates well with MS Office 2000 to 2003, though it did not integrate with Office 2007 on our test PC. At \$499, it's the price that's the pain. If creating PDFs is what you need, there are free programs for the purpose; it's the security and data-sharing facilities in Acrobat 8 that can prove to be of immense value for some.

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

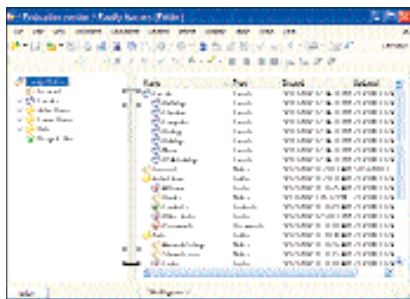
Contact: Adobe Systems Ind P Ltd
Phone: 0120-2444711
E-mail: prsingh@adobe.com
Website: www.adobe.com
Price: Rs. 25,000

WinOrganizer 4.0

All neat and tidy

Here's a personal information manager that not only manages contacts, appointments, tasks, and notes, but can also store your passwords.

The two-pane interface is easy to grasp, and the tree-like folder structure makes accessing the main modules (Contacts, Events, Notes, Passwords, and Tasks) very easy. You can achieve most tasks via a right-click. You can also add and rearrange folders and organize them as you deem fit. Documents and folders can be secured by password-protecting them,



and there is also the provision to assign user-level security.

Weaknesses: to import Outlook contacts, you first need to export them to CSV format. To sync with a Pocket PC, you need to shell out an extra \$20 (Rs 900) for the plugin, and there is no provision to sync with a Palm PDA—a big letdown! WinOrganizer 4.0 costs \$55 (Rs 2,500), a bit expensive for a PIM.

Contact: : TGS Labs
Web site: www.tgslabs.com
Price: Rs. \$55 (Rs 2,500)

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

TuneUp Utilities 2007

Towards a slick 'n' fast XP

After a few months of use, XP has this habit of slowing down and cluttering up your hard drive with useless files. TuneUp Utilities 2007 steps in and makes life easier for you by getting XP back on track.

The program has several powerful and well-designed utilities that can access the Windows maintenance toolset in a fast, organized, easy-to-use, modular interface.

One-click optimization makes managing temporary files and cleaning the Registry and unwanted startup programs easy. There is a variety of Internet and Windows acceleration tools.

The crash-preventing MemOptimizer, a deleted file recovery tool, a file shredder, and an uninstall utility complete the toolset. The "Styler" tool tweaks Windows'



appearance, the Scheduler automates maintenance tasks. In case of an errant program installer, use the RescueCenter to restore all changes at once or one-by-one. The system-analyzing Wizard generates thorough reports and upgrade suggestions. Highly recommended!

Contact: : TuneUp Software
Web site: www.tune-up.com
Price: Rs. \$39.99 (Rs 1,800)

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★